

HACKATHON PITCH — 5 MINUTES

# Breaking Language Barriers

Live translation plus grounded understanding, so no one gets left behind in a workshop run in a language they don't speak.

Deepgram  
STT

DeepL  
Translation

Claude Understanding  
Layer

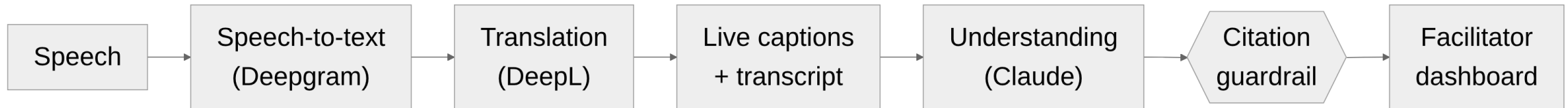
Postgres-  
backed

# Silence is invisible across a language gap

- Online workshops run across languages every day.
- When facilitator and learner don't share one, the facilitator can't tell who's following.
- A lost learner usually stays quiet — by the time anyone notices, the moment to help has passed.

We're solving real-time understanding between facilitators and learners, across languages, in a live session.

# Capture → Translate → Understand — with citations



# Facilitator dashboard

The goal comes from setup. Decision and blocker cards weren't typed by anyone — pulled live from the transcript, each linked to the exact line it came from.

## Facilitator dashboard

### GOAL

Implement a working REST endpoint for user signup, including input validation.

### DECISIONS

Added an early return for a missing email field.

Learner B

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

*"We tried adding `if (!req.body.email) return res.status(400);` but it still errors."*

### CURRENT ACTIVITY

Debugging a 500 error thrown when the email field is empty.

### BLOCKERS

Unclear whether `validateEmail()` throws on empty input.

Learner A

LOW CONFIDENCE

*"It might be that the `validateEmail()` function itself is throwing."*

Live demo · goal / decisions / blockers

4 / 9

1:35 – 2:25 · LIVE DEMO

# Join as a learner, get a translated reply

Scan a QR code, no account setup. Captions translated live, original still visible. Learner questions land on the facilitator's side already translated — replies auto-translate back.

## Facilitator messages

What the remote facilitator has said, in your language and the original.

Facilitator

📶 HIGH CONFIDENCE

试着检查一下 `validateEmail()` 在传入空字符串时是否会抛出异常。

*Try checking whether `validateEmail()` throws when given an empty string.*

Facilitator

📶 HIGH CONFIDENCE

发现得好——把那个调用包在 `try/catch` 里，并记录错误日志来确认。

*Good catch — wrap that call in a `try/catch` and log the error to confirm.*

## Have a question?

Ask in your own language — the facilitator will see it translated.

Ask the facilitator

## Learner questions

Learner B

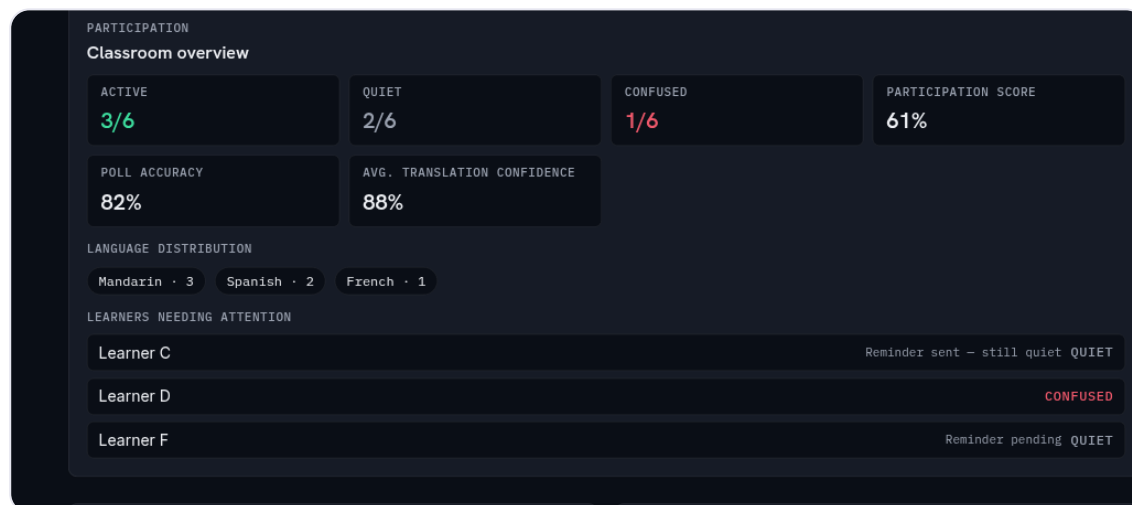
high confidence

`validateEmail()` 是我们自己写的还是用的库？

Is `validateEmail()` something we wrote, or from a library? `code/jargon preserved`

# Quiet-learner nudges & code-aware translation

When a learner goes quiet too long, the facilitator gets nudged — and the learner gets a gentle prompt too. Translation never mangles code: `validateEmail()` and `req.body.email` pass through untouched.



## Live captions

**Facilitator** HIGH CONFIDENCE  
试着检查一下 `validateEmail()` 在传入空字符串时是否会抛出异常。  
*Try checking whether `validateEmail()` throws when given an empty string.*

**Learner A** LOW CONFIDENCE  
It might be that the `validateEmail()` function itself is throwing.  
*可能是 `validateEmail()` 函数本身抛出了异常。*

**Facilitator** HIGH CONFIDENCE  
发现得好——把那个调用包在 `try/catch` 里，并记录错误日志来确认。  
*Good catch — wrap that call in a `try/catch` and log the error to confirm.*

We haven't heard from you in a while — everything okay? Feel free to ask a question or jump into the next poll whenever you're ready.

I'M FOLLOWING ALONG

# Catch-up summary for late joiners

A learner joining late doesn't scroll a wall of transcript — they get a grounded catch-up summary instead, citing the same transcript lines the dashboard cards do.

## Session history

Catch-up summaries for a facilitator joining mid-session or reviewing after.

### Setting up the Express route and request body parsing.

10:02 AM

#### DECISIONS

- Use `express.json()` middleware for body parsing.

### Debugging a 500 error thrown when the email field is empty.

10:14 AM

#### DECISIONS

- Added an early return for a missing email field.

#### BLOCKERS

- Unclear whether `validateEmail()` throws on empty input.

# Grounded by design, real today

## Impact

A quiet learner used to be invisible. Now it's a card on the dashboard.

## Prototype quality

Real Postgres sessions, role-scoped join tokens — not a slide.

## Feasibility

A citation guardrail on top of Deepgram, DeepL, and Claude — APIs we can call today.



4:50 – 5:00 · CLOSE

# Thank you

Breaking Language Barriers — live translation plus grounded understanding, so no one gets left behind in their own workshop.